Dundee Sailing and Rowing Club

August 2026 Newsletter

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Commodore's Corner

Every time I look around the club, I'm reminded of what makes this place so special. Sure, the sailing and rowing are top-notch, but it's the community spirit behind the scenes that really sets us apart - members helping members, welcoming fresh faces, and pitching in whenever called – even if it's scrubbing the slipway or chasing a runaway fender.

A huge, warm welcome to all our new faces! We hope you're settling in nicely and getting stuck into everything the club has to offer. Don't worry if you can't remember everyone's name yet, half of us have been here for years and we're still guessing!

Watersports Showcase – 5th July

The TEWSH (Tay Estuary Water Sports Hub) put on a good show at the Watersports Showcase, with both sailors and rowers getting stuck in. It was good to see other local clubs out together, but I think it's fair to say our members stole a bit of the spotlight.

Our three Wayfarers took to the water, making up an impressive one-third of the impressive dinghy fleet despite the challenging conditions. The Humber safety boat also put on an excellent demonstration of capsize recovery and towing although the "demonstration" came a little earlier than planned after making a rather hasty exit from the parade!

Everyone returned with smiles on their faces … even Rodrigo, who was proving that every dinghy needs a figurehead - even if it's on the wrong side of the boat. 😊

Sailing Round-Up

The past few months has been packed with sailing, and it's been exceptionally busy and very enjoyable sailing. It's been wonderful to see so many boats on the water, with some of the best turnouts we've had in many years.

With sailing continuing to go from strength to strength. We had an impressive 15 boats took to the water with 23 sailors, and the enthusiasm hasn't stopped there, with more 14 boats enjoying some excellent sailing during our weekday evenings.

Our weekend sailing has been just as successful. The Perth sailing and camping trip threw just about every weather condition imaginable at the sailors and making for a memorable adventure. After an action-packed day on the water, they enjoyed a BBQ. Topped off by a night under canvas before sailing back to the club.

Another popular outing didn't stop there. Some members enjoyed a relaxed Sunday sail to the V&A and then onto Wormit beach.

It was great to see many of our long-standing members joining the trip, showing the rest of us that enthusiasm for sailing only get stronger with the years! 😊

A special mention goes to young Michael, who confidently took the helm and steered for most of the journey to Wormit beach with absolute precision, we anchored the wayfarers and everyone gathered on the sea wall to have a picnic. But while the rest of us were slowly roasting like rotisserie chickens in the sun, Kerstin decided she can casually stroll straight into the Tay for a swim - looking remarkably pleased with herself while the rest of us sat there melting in our clothes. 😊😊

On the Oars: Coffee, Tasters and New RP's

Over on the rowing side, things have been buzzing. We've had a steady stream of taster sessions with new faces coming along – and even better coming back. Speaking of those taster sessions, a massive Thank You to Clive, from sending out the information, opening up the club and chatting with every new face and keeping us all in the loop.

A major highlight this month was not one, but two separate rowing trips to Newport for coffee, proving that our rowers are just as dedicated to caffeine as they are to cardio. A huge shout out to Karen and Phil for leading the way and for successfully navigation their first long trip as RPs, and by all accounts, everyone had a great time. "Clive shares the fully story later in this newsletter".

Cox Training is Back! Linda is back at the helm now she's been released from grandparent duties, so cox training sessions are underway once again on a Monday evening – Please check the booking sheet for all dates.

Breaking News: Eider finished her Spa Month

After weeks of intense pampering, deep tissue sanding, and full-body coats of fresh paint, Eider is finally ready to return to the water. She's sporting 2 fresh coats of paint and varnish inside and out, new thole pins, to top it off Derik fitted a snazzy set of new rollers to the trolley to save all our backs.

Fish & Chip Night

Well, that Fish and Chip night was off the scale! What a cracking evening we had, thank you to our increasable Party Planners who went all out. The clubhouse was transformed into a top-tier nautical chippy – "complete with salt, vinegar, a brilliant quiz and incredible hand-crafted bunting and paper boats".

A big shout-out to our Party Planners Pam, Eileen, Rosilynn, Clive, Wendy, Karen, Jennet, Mandy, Phil – Once again, they pulled out for all the stops to make the evening such a success.

Member's Corner

This month club member Clive shares his experience from one of his recent rows:

> *"Two bridges and a bacon roll"- There was an opportunity near the end of July to do a long row upriver pushed by the tide and then return with the tide. The RP did her best to drum up a crew, but it seemed to no avail. Then the advertising tactics changed – with a crew of five we could comfortably do one bridge, with a crew of six we could do both bridges and call at a coffee shop on the way back. Was the coffee shop enough of a pull? It was not 100% successful as we only had 5 crew, the minimum needed, but we could go ahead and have time on the water. Conditions on the day were superb and after only 30 minutes we had reached Newport. We paused and conferred - there were a few doubters in the boat so we compromised by saying we would continue for another 20 minutes. That bit of confabbing cost us as the rising tide was dying fast. Eventually the railway bridge got closer and time was pushed to the back of everyone's mind. A little more effort and perseverance and we were under the railway bridge – a first for everyone on board. After turning around the focus was on Newport and the promised café. We landed on a shingle beach and tramped up to the terrace at Shoreline. Bacon rolls, egg rolls - there may have been others – scones with cream and jam were served up along with tea and various coffees. Whatever*

> *aches and pains may have existed were lost in the endless chatter. And then back to the boat and home. One other first was scored that day; our RP was acting alone for the first time. I don't know if we managed to embarrass her with our congratulations and applause, but we did try hard.*

If you have a story or experience you would like to share, please let me know. It would be great to make it a regular feature of the newsletter.

Workshop Corner & Wash Down Hose Reel

Just a couple of friendly reminders. Whether you're working on the skiff, your own boat, or using the workshop, please remember to leave your work area nice and tidy when you've finished and put tools or equipment back where they belong. Unfortunately, the Tool Fairy is on holiday, and nobody is coming in overnight to sweep up after us.

One final favour, please. After using the wash-down hose reel, could you leave it on the east side of the workshop, beside the clothing store (where the sailing gear is kept), it's starting to rust, and keeping it there will help.

DSRC Calendar – Order Yours Now



Packed with brilliant sailing and rowing photos, our club calendar for £10. Buy one for yourself, pick one a few extra for friends or family? Whether they live just around the corner or on the other side of the world.

Please pay through the Club bank account: Reference 'calendar', Sort Code: 80-22-60, Acc No: 29413263.

Dates to Remember

- Cox Training Session - started again, please see booking sheets
- Safety Helm Refresher - Saturday 8th August
- Boat Shed Paint & Soup Day - 12th August
- Fifie Friday - Date to follow
- Portsoy Trip - 25-28th August
- DSRC Beach Bonfire Night, live music with the Doolichters in the boathouse - Saturday 29th August
- Bell Rock - 4th September
- Forfar Regatta - Saturday 17th October

Until Next time

Remember, rowers are the only athletes who spend an entire workout staring at where they have just been, while dinghy sailors are the only people who tie themselves into human knots just to pray for a breeze to get home for tea. Keep the pointy end forward, don't drop the rudder, and if all else fails - blame the tide! 😊

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